

1. 'My baby. Lucille, is named after you,' said Fran.
Who is Fran talking to?

2. "Happy Mother's Day!" said the man, handing a bunch of flowers to the smiling woman.
Who is the man?

3. Alex was pleased that Katrina let him play in the last game of the tournament.

4. THE TRUCK

The wipers could hardly keep the windscreen clear of water. The driver looked for a place to pull off the road. The truck appeared suddenly as a massive shape swerving around the car with its horn blaring.

a. Why was the driver looking for a place to pull off the road?

b. Why was the truck driver blaring his horn?

5. SUE

Sue enjoyed traveling in the car, but she could never stay still. She was constantly excited by whatever she saw, especially things that moved. We were travelling down a quiet country road one lazy Sunday afternoon. Sue, balancing on her four short legs between the headrests of the front seat, spotted a hawk that rose up in front of the car. With a growl she lunged at it. It took several minutes for her to recover.

a. What is Sue?

b. What happened to Sue after she lunged?

7. JUMBO

Language is constantly changing. Words are invented, meanings are changed and some words are lost.

Mumbo-jumbo is thought to be an African term for a witch doctor who carried out seemingly strange ceremonies. In English, mumbo-jumbo took on the meaning for something that is either mysterious or meaningless.

In 1884 a circus owner named P.T. Barnum bought an enormous male elephant from London Zoo. He named the elephant Jumbo and shipped it to America to take it on tour. It was the largest known elephant in captivity. Barnum's advertising posters showed a huge elephant with the name Jumbo written in large letters.

Soon the word jumbo was being added to anything that was especially large. There were jumbo meals, jumbo fruits - the new word could be added to any product. In more modern times we got the 'jumbo jet'. This was the nickname given to the Boeing 747 aircraft - a plane with a large, distinctive hump. This plane could carry more passengers than any other.

For about a year Jumbo was exhibited across America. Then, one night as he was being led across some railway tracks to board the train which would take him to his next destination, another train arrived unexpectedly and ran straight into him. Neither he nor the train survived the collision, but the word jumbo continues to be part of the English language.

a. Why did the African word mumbo-jumbo come to mean something mysterious in English?

b. Why did P. T. Barnum want to take this elephant on tour?

c. How did the word jumbo come to be used for anything that was especially large?

d. Why is the Boeing 747 called a Jumbo jet'?

e. What happened to the train that hit Jumbo?